DC01 Security Remediation Assessment

Personal lab assessment | Evidence date October 23, 2026 | Prepared by Musah Issah

Assessment conclusion

Evidence supports closure of two selected DC01 configuration findings following documented changes and authenticated verification scans on October 23, 2026. The result demonstrates a traceable remediation process within this lab assessment, rather than an overall compliance determination.

Business purpose and scope

DC01 is the Windows Server 2022 domain controller at 192.168.77.10 for ad.northstar.test. It supports authentication and name resolution. In a business environment, compromise or disruption could affect access to systems and business operations; no actual business loss was measured in this lab. The objective was to identify, address, and verify the two selected weaknesses.

Assessment approach

The initial scan accepted SMB credentials but could not complete credentialed checks because of access limitations. That scan was not treated as a complete baseline. A subsequent privileged scan reported Auth Pass and credentialed checks yes. Baseline findings were recorded, a DC01-filtered Group Policy Object was applied, registry settings were checked, and authenticated rescans were reviewed after restarts.

Finding and evidence traceability

DC01-VULN-001 | WinVerifyTrust | Nessus High | CVSS 3.0 8.8. LAB-CHG-012 set EnableCertPaddingCheck to 1 in both registry locations. EV-003 records the baseline; EV-005 and EV-006 support GPO application and registry verification; EV-008 supports no longer detected status in the authenticated rescan. EV-007 is the operator-reported post-restart health check.

DC01-VULN-002 | Intel BHI configuration | Nessus Low | CVSS 3.0 6.5. LAB-CHG-013 set FeatureSettingsOverride to 8388608 and its mask to 3. EV-004 and EV-009 record the baseline; EV-010 and EV-011 support implementation; EV-012 supports final authenticated verification. EV-013 is the operator-reported post-restart health check.

Evidence quality and limitations

The repository retains 50 screenshots. Evidence IDs identify supporting records, Finding IDs identify the weaknesses, and Change IDs explain the remediation. Post-restart service and Active Directory checks, and removal of the saved privileged scan credential, were operator confirmed without retained screenshots. The operator implemented and verified the changes; no independent approval was recorded. Physical host protection, recovery testing, and full application compatibility were not established. An earlier unverified SMB finding remains a historical discrepancy, not a closed finding.

Conclusion and next steps

Retain both selected findings as closed within the documented scan scope and preserve their original scores. Review future scan results for recurrence. For a business assessment, obtain an independent review, agree remediation timeframes, and define ongoing monitoring before using this record to support a broader risk or authorization decision.

Source records: Tracking workbook | Change record 012 and 013 | Evidence index and screenshots